WEEK 2 · LESSON 7 OF 24 · HANDOUT

The AI-Ready Mindset

Study time: **about 35 minutes** (reading, video and activity)

▶ **Watch:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XLoMFXGTczU — open the lesson online to watch inside the course.

🎓 **Go deeper:** Harvard CS50x 2026: Artificial Intelligence — full lecture — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-9bo8HlSxwQ

Your goal in this lesson: Adopt a practical mindset for working with AI: use it to augment your work, stay in charge of judgement, and build safe daily habits.

Augment, don't abdicate

The most useful way to think about AI is as a **very fast, very well-read assistant who sometimes gets things wrong**. You stay the professional. The assistant drafts, summarises, explains and suggests. You decide, check and take responsibility.

Two mistakes to avoid:

- **Over-trusting** — copying whatever AI says. People who do this end up submitting wrong figures, fake references or advice that does not fit Rwanda.
- **Refusing to try** — avoiding AI completely. People who do this slowly fall behind colleagues who finish routine work faster.

The sweet spot is in the middle: **let AI do the heavy lifting, keep your hand on the wheel.**

Three roles AI can play for you

Role	What it looks like	Example
Assistant	Does a task you describe	"Draft a polite reminder email to a client."
Tutor	Explains and quizzes you	"Explain VAT like I'm new to accounting, then ask me 3 questions."
Thinking partner	Challenges your ideas	"Here is my business plan. What are the 5 biggest weaknesses?"

Most beginners only use the first role. Strong users use all three.

Where you must stay in charge

- Anything where a mistake costs money, health, safety, a grade or someone's reputation.
- Facts that change: prices, laws, dates, names of current officials.
- Your **voice and values** — the final message should sound like you and reflect your judgement.
- Personal and confidential information (we cover this fully in Week 4).

Five daily habits of AI-ready professionals

1. **Start with a clear goal.** Know what "good" looks like before you ask.

2. **Give context.** AI does far better when it knows who you are, who the audience is and why.
3. **Iterate.** Treat the first answer as a draft. Ask for changes.
4. **Verify.** Check facts, numbers and references that matter.
5. **Reflect.** Notice what AI did well and where it failed, so you get better at choosing tasks for it.

A simple question before every AI task

> *"What would a good result look like, and how will I check it?"*

If you cannot answer, first learn the basics of the task yourself. Then let AI speed you up.

Remember this: Treat AI as an assistant, tutor and thinking partner — never as a replacement for your own judgement and responsibility.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Activity

Task 1

Make two columns: **"AI could help with…"** and **"I must stay in charge of…"**.

Task 2

Fill each column with at least three points.

Task 3

Try the AI role "thinking partner": paste a short piece of your own work and ask *"What are three ways this could be clearer?"* Decide which suggestions you accept and why.

Self-check

Think about your answers here, then take the quiz online — it is marked instantly and explains every answer.

1. What does 'augment, don't abdicate' mean?

   A. Never use AI

   B. Use AI to boost your work while you keep judgement and responsibility

   C. Only use AI on weekends

   D. Let AI make all decisions

2. Which is an example of using AI as a TUTOR?

A. Asking it to draft an email
B. Asking it to translate a menu
C. Asking it to explain VAT and then quiz you
D. Asking it to make a poster

3. Which is a sign of OVER-TRUSTING AI?

A. Checking the references it gives
B. Using it to brainstorm
C. Asking it to improve your draft
D. Submitting its figures without checking them

4. Which task should you keep firmly in your own control?

A. Reformatting notes into a table
B. Fixing grammar in a draft
C. Brainstorming slogan ideas
D. Deciding whether to approve a large payment

5. What should you ask yourself before every AI task?

A. How fast is my internet?
B. Can AI do it without me?
C. Which AI is the most famous?
D. What would a good result look like, and how will I check it?

6. Using AI as a 'thinking partner' means…

A. Asking it to tell jokes
B. Letting it think instead of you
C. Using two AI tools at once
D. Asking it to challenge and improve your ideas

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